When AI Executes, Leaders Decide

Build & Lead:
Tech Leaders
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GS

IN YOUR SHOES

NEXT COHORT

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4.7 (8)

Decision Framing

Decision Framing

What is a Frame

Decision: What do we think we are deciding?

Boundaries: What have we implicitly put in or out of scope?

Viewpoint: From whose perspective are we seeing the issue?

Decision Framing

Decision Framing

Decision Framing

Wrong frame: "Can we justify launching?"

Better frame: "What would make launching unjustifiable, and have we ruled that out?"

Decision Framing

Notice what frames you and others are using

↓

Evaluate whether your frames fit the problem

↓

Else, find or build a better frame

Decision Framing

Kodak missed the digital revolution

Decision Framing

Digital photography begins to emerge. Kodak has already invented the first digital camera in 1975 and later developed key digital imaging technology, but its film business is still highly valuable

Decision Framing

Notice what frames are being used

We are treating the problem as mainly a: Business Protection

We are assuming success means: Preserving film revenues, enter digital carefully

We are focusing mostly on: Cannibalization risk, protecting margins

The decision looks like: How do we respond to digital photography without destroying our film business?

Decision Framing

Help us identify the current frame Kodak leadership is using for the digital photography decision.

Our current question is:
“How do we respond to digital photography without destroying our film business?”

Using our internal strategy documents, leadership discussions, financials, customer research, market intelligence, R&D priorities, and capability assessments:

Describe the frame we are currently using
Identify its embedded assumptions
Explain what success we seem to be optimizing for
Show what this frame makes us focus on
Highlight what may be outside our awareness

Do not reframe or recommend strategy yet. Focus only on making our current frame visible.

+ Thinking

AI is acting as a **mirror**.

Decision Framing

Evaluate whether their frames fit the problem

Frame is helpful	Frame is NOT helpful
Film highly profitable	Customer is loyal to capturing and sharing images
digital could cannibalize the core	digital is a business-model shift
moving too fast could hurt short-term earnings	the real competitive question is future relevance
the transition carries risk	protecting film may delay transformation

Decision Framing

Evaluate whether Kodak's current strategic frame — "How do we respond to digital photography without destroying our film business?" — still fits our internal reality and future outlook.

Use our internal financials, customer insights, R&D data, market intelligence, competitor analysis, and capability assessments.

Please answer:

What assumptions are embedded in this frame?
What does it help us see?
What does it cause us to miss?
Where does internal evidence support or contradict it?
What better framing options should we consider?

Do not recommend a strategy yet. Focus on whether this is the right frame for the decision.

+ Thinking

AI is acting as a **challenger**.

Decision Framing

find or build a better frame

- Stop Treating the decision as Protection
- Generate several genuinely different candidate frames
- Choose the frame that best matches the real strategic challenge

Decision Framing

Help us build a better strategic frame for Kodak than:
“How do we respond to digital photography without destroying our film business?”

Using our internal financials, customer insights, market intelligence, R&D data, capability assessments, and competitor analysis:

Generate 5 alternative frames for this decision
Explain what each frame assumes, highlights, and misses
Define what success means under each frame
Assess which frames best fit Kodak’s actual situation
Recommend 1–2 strongest candidate framing options

Do not recommend a strategy yet. Focus only on building better frames.

+ Thinking

AI as
Reframing Generator

Decision Framing

Else, find or build a better frame

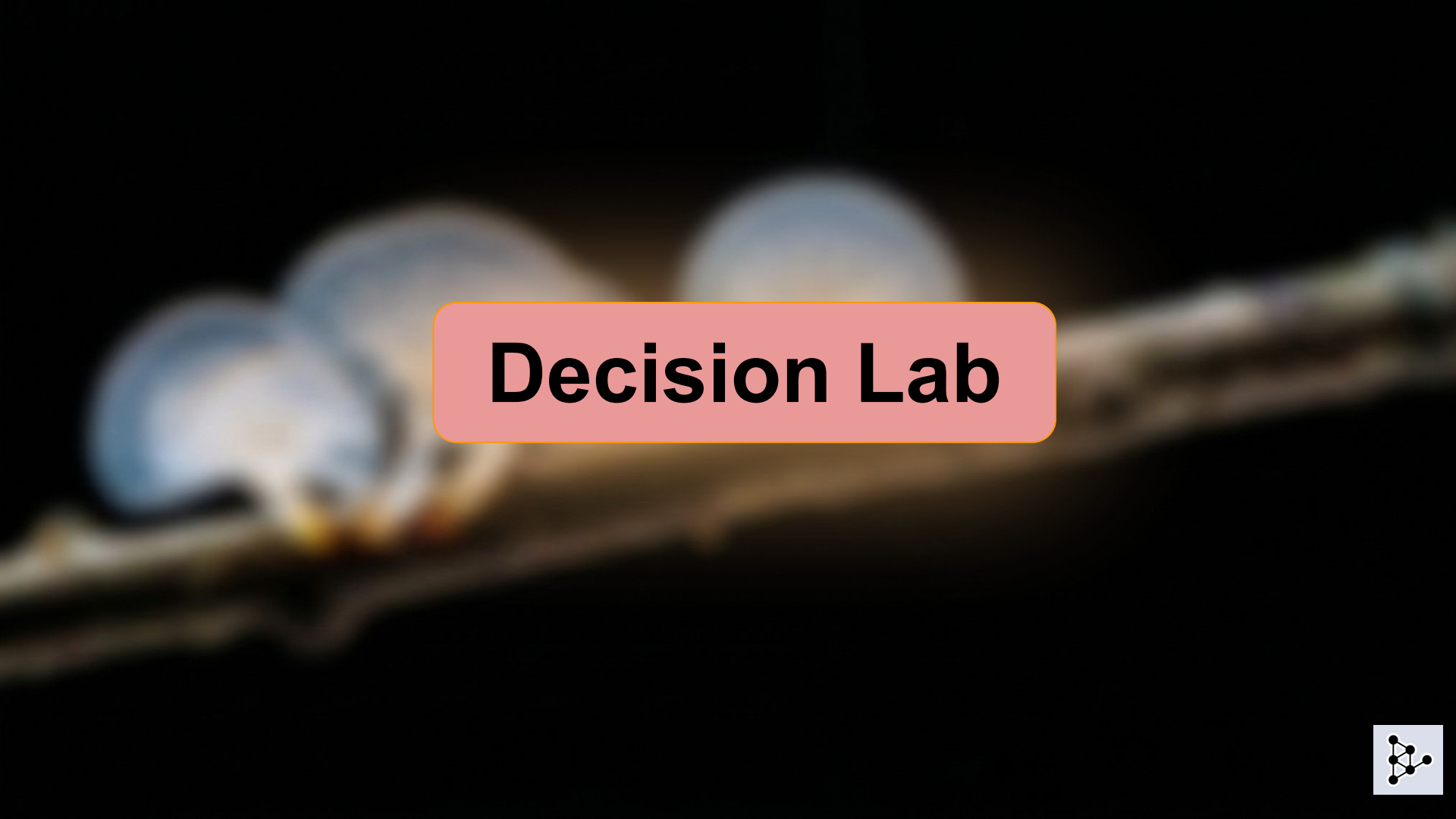
Kodak is in the business of helping people capture, manage, share, and preserve images, ***regardless of medium****.*

Decision Framing

Mirror

Challenger

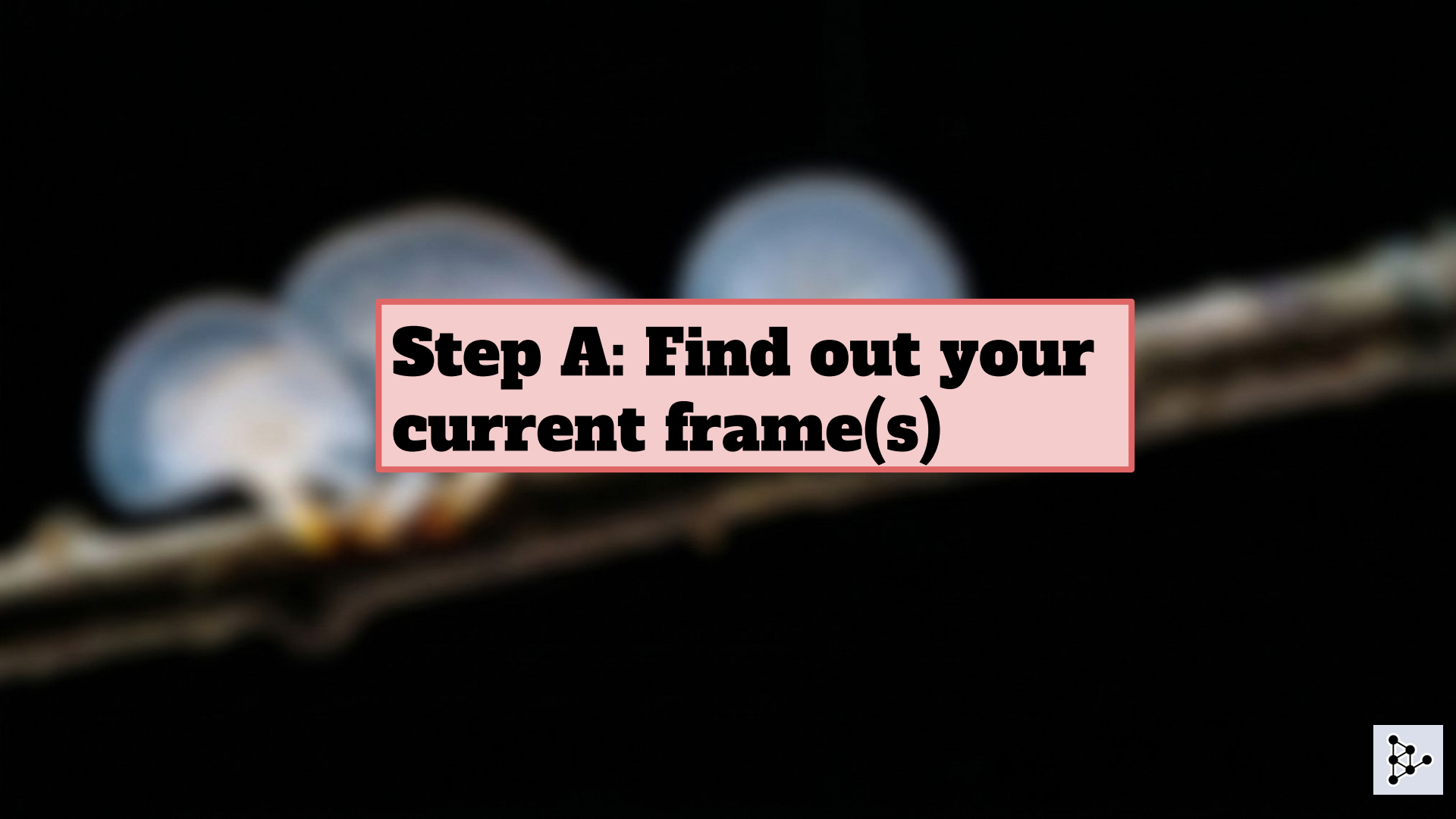
Reframing Generator


Decision Lab

Find Winning Frame(s)

2 Scenarios

Breakout Group



Step A: Find out your current frame(s)

In your group,

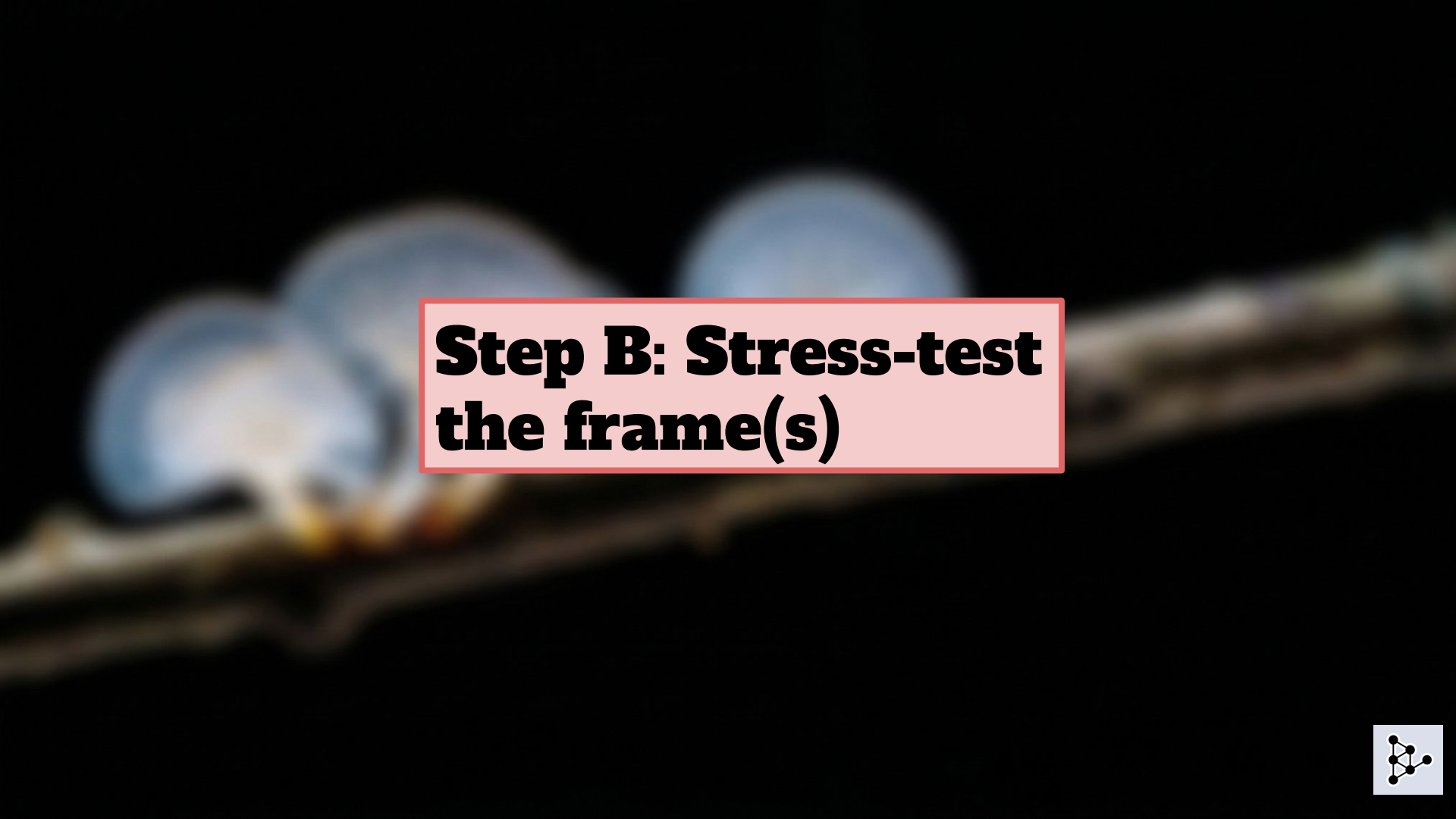
What frames are we using now?

The decision looks like: _____

We are treating the problem as mainly a: _____

We are assuming success means: _____

We are focusing mostly on: _____



Step B: Stress-test the frame(s)

In your group,

Are these the right frames for the decision?

What does this frame help us see clearly?

What does this frame help us see clearly?

Who would disagree with this frame?

What important trade-off is being underplayed?

Is this frame too narrow, too operational, too political, too financial, too urgent?

Step C: Find or Build new frames

In your group,

What frames would lead to a better decision?

A better frame for this decision is: _____

Under this frame, the real decision becomes: _____

The most important trade-off becomes: _____

Scenario 1

Your company has piloted an internal AI assistant for drafting client emails, meeting summaries, and proposal outlines. Early feedback is positive: teams report saving time, adoption is spreading informally, and several senior leaders want to expand it quickly across sales, operations, and HR.

However, Legal has raised concerns about confidential data being pasted into the tool. HR is worried managers may start using AI-generated summaries in performance discussions without context. The IT security lead says the pilot was never designed for enterprise-wide use. Meanwhile, a competitor has publicly announced a company-wide AI productivity rollout, and your CEO is asking why your company is moving slowly.

You are on the executive team. A decision is needed within 2 weeks.

Known facts

- Pilot users report average time savings of 20–30% on routine drafting tasks.
- No known major incident has occurred yet.
- There are no finalized internal policies for acceptable AI use.
- The company handles sensitive client and employee information.
- Employee sentiment is mixed: enthusiasm from some teams, caution from others.
- The CEO wants a visible signal of progress this quarter.

Do you scale now, pause, limit rollout, or redesign the rollout approach?

Scenario 2

A regional business unit is underperforming and needs a new leader. One candidate is a star executive with a strong record of delivering growth, moving fast, and making tough calls. Several board members support the promotion.

However, internal feedback suggests this leader leaves behind strained teams, high attrition, and weak cross-functional relationships. In the last role, results improved sharply, but employee engagement scores fell and two senior people resigned. There has been no formal misconduct finding, but concerns are well known. The current business context is difficult: the unit needs a turnaround in the next 12 months, but morale is already fragile.

The CEO wants a recommendation by the end of the week.

Known facts

- Candidate has exceeded revenue targets in 3 of the last 4 years.
- Previous team attrition was 22%, versus a company average of 11%.
- Employee survey comments describe the leader as “brilliant,” “demanding,” and “hard to trust.”
- No formal policy violation or ethical breach has been substantiated.
- The business unit needs both performance improvement and organizational stability.
- There is one internal alternative candidate with a stronger people reputation but less turnaround experience.

Do you appoint the high performer, choose the steadier alternative, delay, split the role, or redesign the mandate?

Resolve Tension between AI and Human Decision Making

4 Tensions

Breakout Group

4 Tensions

Speed over depth

With AI, there is a bias now to move as quickly as possible without thoughtful and clear thinking. Who has time to read the full document when a summary has the done the job, and there is no value in depth anymore when information can be easily accessed and summarized to my taste

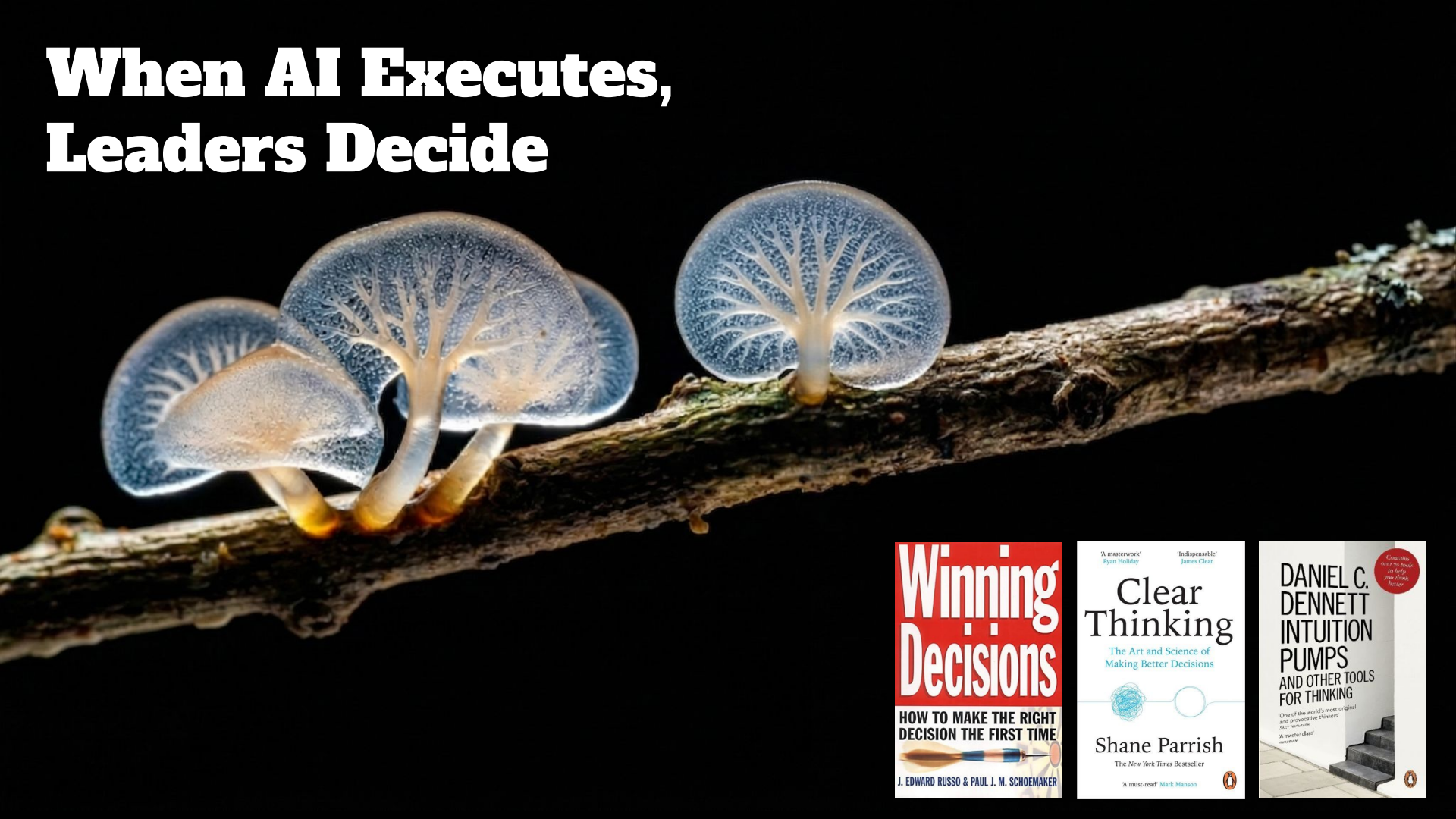
Good-enough vs high-fidelity decisions

When 60-75% is good enough to move, AI reliance may be better. When nothing less than 90-95% is good enough to move, AI reliance is risky. What AI may solve for is the peripheral vision of decision making (optimize for speed, but not fidelity)

Rationality vs irrationality

How does AI affect human rationality and irrationality when making decisions ? The tendency to ground all human rationales and thinking in 'rationality' often limits truly brave decisions as the tendency for AI is to avoid irrationality in all cases. But does irrationality in decisions always lead to good decisions?

Consequence and accountability

Lack of consequence limits good decisions. AI does not have to face consequences for real world decisions, and hence it is biased towards safety and generally risk aversive decisions

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